

HOYEON LEE

Public and Urban Policy · The New School for Social Research · New York, NY
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EDUCATION

The New School for Social Research

New York, NY

Ph.D. Candidate, Public and Urban Policy — Expected Spring 2027

M.Phil., Public and Urban Policy — 2026

Yonsei University

Seoul, Korea

M.A., Public Administration — Aug. 2018

Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy, NUS

Singapore

Exchange Research Fellow (Funded by the National Research Foundation of Korea) — 2017

Yonsei University

Seoul, Korea

B.A., Public Administration — Feb. 2015

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I study how labor market institutions evolve under technological and global change, and how that institutional change reshapes workers' opportunities and inequality — across automation, platform work, and migration.

Keywords: Comparative Political Economy; Labor Market Institutions; Inequality; Automation; Platform Work; Migration

DISSERTATION

Title: Rethinking Labor Market Inequality in South Korea: Automation, Institutions, and Stratification

Committee: Sakiko Fukuda-Parr (Chair), Will Milberg, Ying Chen

Description: Develops a theory of how labor market institutions mediate technological change and reshape inequality. Focusing on automation in Korea, the dissertation uses longitudinal panel data (KLIPS) and interviews to show that institutionalized employment structures — not automation itself — determine how economic risk is reallocated across stratified employment relations, reorganizing inequality beyond wage dispersion.

JOB MARKET PAPER

Lee, Hoyeon. "From Polarization to Dualization: How Labor Market Stratification Filters Automation Shocks in Korea."

Dissertation chapter. Full draft available.

Awarded the 2026 David Marsden Best Paper Prize (SASE) and the 2026 LERA/AILR Best Paper Competition award.

Selected Presentations

Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE) Annual Conference, Bordeaux, France, 2026.

Labor and Employment Relations Association (LERA), 78th Annual Meeting, Minneapolis, MN, 2026.

World Inequality Conference, Paris School of Economics, Paris, France, 2026.

Korean Association of Labor Studies (KALS), Summer Conference for Emerging Researchers, Seoul, August 2026.

WORKING PAPERS

Lee, Hoyeon. "Programming Apps, Programming Workers: Algorithmic Control and the Institutionalization of Autonomy." Examines platform work as an emerging, privately governed labor market institution based on existing institutions.

Fieldwork in Kerala, India (Summer 2026; Starr Fellowship), including interviews with auto-rickshaw and taxi drivers; trade union and driver-association presidents and senior leaders; heads of labor and transport research institutions; State Planning Board members; and scholars. Presented at ISA RC21 (Vienna) and WINIR (Rome).

Lee, Hoyeon. "Institutional Void, Moral Economy, and Consented Endurance: How Educated Young Korean Women Migrant Workers Accept Exploitation." Shows how informal institutions govern migrant labor incorporation.

Selected Presentations: IAFFE 2026 (Cali), ASSA2027 (accepted), Funded by the ASE William R. Waters Research Grant

Lee, Hoyeon. "The Political Economy of Flexibility as Necessity: How Labor Market and Welfare Failures Create Demand for Platform Work." Examines how gaps in employment and welfare systems generate platform labor demand.

Selected Presentations: The XXI ISA World Congress of Sociology 2027 (accepted/ invited session).

AWARDS, GRANTS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Recipient, Outstanding Graduate Student Teaching Award, The New School for Social Research, 2026 — \$300

Awarded annually in recognition of excellence in graduate teaching based on nominations from students and faculty.

Winner, David Marsden Best Paper Prize, Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE), 2026 — \$500

Awarded annually to a single paper presented at the SASE Annual Conference, recognizing outstanding theory-driven research on labor markets, employment relations, and institutions (Jury Citation).

Winner, LERA/AILR Best Paper Competition, Labor and Employment Relations Association, 2026

William R. Waters Research Grant, Association for Social Economics (ASE), 2026 — \$5,000

Supports qualitative interviews with migrant workers in New York and New Jersey examining labor market institutions and migrant labor stratification.

Starr Student Award, India China Institute, 2026 — \$3,500

Funds fieldwork in Kerala, India, including interviews with platform workers examining algorithmic labor control and institutional dimensions of platform work.

WINIR Young Scholar, World Interdisciplinary Network for Institutional Research, 2026 — €300

Travel Grant, International Association for Feminist Economics (IAFFE), 2026 — \$1,250

Research Grant, Youth Hub, Seoul Metropolitan Government, 2020 — \$17,000 (KRW 20 million)

Principal Investigator; Quantitative study of technological change and youth employment using national labor force and youth panel data, comparing employment patterns across age groups and regions to inform youth employment policy.

Winner, Best Article Award in Labor and Welfare Studies, Institute for Welfare State Research (IWSR), 2018

NSPE PhD Scholarship, The New School, 2019–2021

Isador Lubin Scholarship, The New School, 2019–2021

Yonsei University Public Administration (YUPA) Excellence Award, Yonsei University, 2017

Brain Korea 21 Plus Scholarship, National Research Foundation of Korea, 2015–2018

PUBLICATIONS (PEER-REVIEWED)

Lee, Hoyeon, and Jae-jin Yang. 2017. "Who Are Outsiders in the South Korean Labor Market?" *Korean Policy Studies Review* (한국정책학회보), 26(2), 65–104.

Yang, Jae-jin, Hoyeon Lee, and Jung-ju Lee. 2016. "Life Satisfaction and Inequality of Opportunity for Happiness among the Elderly in Korea." *Social Science Review* (사회과학연구), 47(2).

Lee, Hoyeon. 2019. "Persistence and Change in Local Government Welfare Policy: Evidence from School Meal Programs in South Korea." *Policy Research* (정책연구), 3(1): 1–31.

Under Review

Basu, Debasmita, Hoyeon Lee, and Annie Hua. "When Beliefs Shape Literacy: An Examination of Confirmation Bias in Students' Interpretation of Misleading Graphs." Under review at *Journal of Mathematical Behavior*.

BOOK CHAPTERS

Lee, Hoyeon. Forthcoming. "Institutional Void, Moral Economy, and Consented Endurance: How Educated Young Korean Women Migrant Workers Accept Exploitation." In John B. Davis (ed.), *Stratification Economics in the Global Economy*. Routledge. (Invited chapter)

Lee, Hoyeon, and Jae-Jin Yang. 2018. "Quality of Labor Market and Quality of Life in South Korea." In MJ Moon (ed.), *Government Quality and Quality of Life*. Seoul: Moonwoosa.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Cho, Yoosun, Hoyeon Lee, and Yena Lee. 2020. *The Effect of Technological Changes on the Youth Labor Market in South Korea*. Seoul: Youth Hub, Seoul Metropolitan Government.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- "The Political Economy of Flexibility as Necessity: How Labor Market and Welfare Failures Create Demand for Platform Work." In session Contesting the Future of Work: Gender, Digital Power and Labour Inequalities across Global Contexts, **RC02 Economy and Society, XXI ISA World Congress of Sociology**, Gwangju, South Korea, July 2027. (Accepted/Invited Session)
- "Institutional Voids, Moral Economy, and Consented Endurance: Why Highly Educated Migrants Remain in Exploitative Work." **Association for Social Economics session, Annual Meeting of the Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA)**, Washington, D.C., January 2027. (Accepted)
- "From Polarization to Dualization: How Labor Market Stratification Filters Automation Shocks in Korea." **Korean Association of Labor Studies (KALS)**, Summer Conference for Emerging Researchers, Session 1: Labor Market, Yonsei University, Seoul, August 2026.
- "Programming Apps, Programming Workers: Algorithmic Control and the Institutionalization of Autonomy." **RC21 Conference on Sociology of Urban and Regional Development, International Sociological Association**, Session #18: Urban Subjectivities in Platform Labour: Class, Precarity, and Everyday Experiences of the Digital City, Vienna, Austria, July 2026.
- "Programming Apps, Programming Workers: Algorithmic Control and the Institutionalization of Autonomy." Young Scholars Pre-Conference Workshop, **World Interdisciplinary Network for Institutional Research (WINIR)**, Rome, Italy, 2026. (Selected young scholar; travel stipend awarded)
- "Institutional Void, Moral Economy, and Consented Endurance: How Highly Educated Women Migrant Workers Come to Accept Exploitation." **International Association for Feminist Economics (IAFFE)** 34th Annual Conference, Cali, Colombia, July 2026.
- "From Polarization to Dualization: How Labor Market Stratification Filters Automation Shocks in Korea." **Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE) Annual Conference**, Bordeaux, France, July 2026. (*David Marsden Best Paper Prize*)
- "From Polarization to Dualization: How Labor Market Stratification Filters Automation Shocks in Korea." **World Inequality Conference, Paris School of Economics**, Paris, France, June 2026.
- "From Polarization to Dualization: How Labor Market Stratification Filters Automation Shocks in Korea." **Labor and Employment Relations Association (LERA)**, 78th Annual Meeting, Minneapolis, MN, May 2026. (*LERA/AILR Best Paper Competition*)
- Basu, Debasmita, and Hoyeon Lee. "The Role of Confirmation Bias in Interpreting Political Graphs." The National Numeracy Network 2025 Annual Meeting, Nov. 2025.
- "The Effect of Technological Changes on the Youth Labor Market." **2020 Annual Conference of Youth Hub and Seoul Metropolitan Government**, Nov. 2020.
- Lee, Hoyeon, and Jae-jin Yang. "Who Are the Outsiders in the South Korean Labor Market?" **Korean Academy of Social Welfare (KASW)** Spring Conference, Seoul, South Korea, May 12, 2017.
- Lee, Hoyeon, and Jae-jin Yang. "Who Are the Outsiders in the South Korean Labor Market?" **Korean Association for Governance Studies (KAGS)** Winter Conference, February 2017.
- "The Effects of Collaborative Governance on Policy Performance." **Korean Association for Governance Studies (KAGS)** Winter Conference, February 2017.
- "The Effects of Collaborative Governance on Policy Performance." **Seoul Association for Public Administration Annual Conference**, Seoul, South Korea, February 2017.
- "Persistence and Change in Universal Free School Meal Policy in South Korea: A Fuzzy-set Analysis of Government Partisanship." **Korean Association for Local Government Studies (KALGS)**, International Summer Conference, Seongnam, South Korea, August 2016.
- Yang, Jae-jin, Hoyeon Lee, and Jungjoo Lee. "Life Satisfaction and Inequality of Opportunity for Happiness among Older Adults in Korea." **The Korean Association for Policy Studies (KAPS), Annual Conference**, June 18, 2016.
- Lee, Hoyeon, and Seo-eun (Grace) Jeong. "The Dynamics of the Expansion of Korea's Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC) and Changes in Its Beneficiary Groups." **Korean Association for Public Administration Theory (KAPAT) Annual Conference**, Jeju National University, Jeju, South Korea, August 20, 2015.
- Lee, Hoyeon, and Intae Choi. "The Effects of Minimum Wage Increases on Youth Employment." **Korean Association for Governance Studies (KAGS), Annual Conference**, Yonsei University, Seoul, August 17, 2015.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow (Instructor of Record), Quantitative Reasoning I & II (undergraduate) 2022–Present

The New School (ten semesters)

- Recipient, **Outstanding Graduate Student Teaching Award**, The New School for Social Research, 2026.
- Sole instructor; averaged 4.63/5.0 on overall course evaluations across semesters (2023–2026), with recurring student feedback highlighting accessibility, real-world applicability, and effective use of software tools (R, Excel, Tableau).
- Designed a full curriculum integrating mathematics, statistics, and social-science applications; developed the QR-II curriculum around regression modeling, data visualization, and applied analysis using R.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Economics in International Affairs (graduate) 2021–2023

The New School — Assisted lecture and seminar delivery for graduate students.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Incoming Jury Member, David Marsden Best Paper Prize 2027–2029

Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE), Network G

Discussant, Feminist Economics Seminar Series Oct. 2025

"Towards a Gender-Inclusive Social Policy State." International Association for Feminist Economics (IAFFE)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Fellow (Working Group Member), AI and Its Social Impacts Research Project 2026–Present

Korea Information Society Development Institute (KISDI)

Responsible for the labor market adjustment and social protection pillars, developing cross-national institutional indicators and datasets on workforce adaptation, redistribution, and inequality under AI-driven transformation.

Research Collaborator, Graphical Literacy & Misinformation Project 2023–Present

Advisor: Debasmita Basu

Research design, IRB protocols, interview and survey instrument development, literature review, data collection, qualitative analysis, and conceptual development of research on critical statistical literacy, prior beliefs, and the interpretation of misleading data visualizations.

Platform Cooperativism Research Fellow 2021–2022

Platform Cooperativism Consortium

Conducted research on platform labor, worker cooperatives, and digital labor institutions; contributed to manuscript development for *Own This!: How Platform Cooperatives Help Workers Build a Democratic Internet* (Verso, 2023) through research, source verification, empirical fact-checking, and substantive review. Organized a comprehensive archive of web based and organizational source materials on platform cooperativism, later incorporated into the Consortium's website.

Principal Investigator, "Technology and Youth Employment" 2020

Youth Hub, Seoul Metropolitan Government

Led an independent quantitative study on technological change and youth employment, managing the full research process from research design and data analysis to policy evaluation, stakeholder coordination, and final report preparation.

Research Assistant, Job Quality Project 2019–2022

The New School for Social Research

Project: Washington Center for Equitable Growth–funded Job Quality Project

Constructed the Institutional Bargaining Power Index, contributing to its conceptualization and empirical design, and harmonized cross-national microdata from the CPS and national household and labor force surveys across five countries. Conducted the empirical analyses and produced tables and figures underlying a series of working papers (Howell 2021a, 2021b) and a peer-reviewed article in *Oxford Open Economics* (Howell and Kalleberg 2024) on cross-country labor market inequality, job quality, and labor market institutions.

Research Fellow, Institute for Welfare State Research, Yonsei University 2015–2018

Advisor: Jae-Jin Yang

Conducted empirical and policy-oriented research on labor markets, welfare systems, and inequality across multiple government- and foundation-funded projects. Contributed to quantitative analysis, institutional evaluation, and policy assessment supporting national and local government agencies.

- Ministry of Health and Welfare (Korea) and OECD collaboration: Estimated local government welfare expenditures and analyzed regional variation in welfare fiscal capacity.
- National Research Foundation: Examined structural transformation of the Korean welfare state and social risk inequality.
- Suwon City Government: Conducted institutional evaluation and performance assessment of municipal research and administrative systems.
- Hankook Ilbo: Evaluated local government welfare systems and institutional performance across regions.
- Korea Foundation: Investigated inequality in happiness and life satisfaction among population groups

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Policy Advisor to Labor Committee Member, National Assembly of Korea 2010–2012
Democratic Labor Party

- Served as one of two labor policy advisors, conducting legislative research and policy analysis on labor markets, employment relations, and labor institutions.
- Conducted field investigations at more than 50 labor dispute sites nationwide, examining labor conditions and institutional compliance through direct engagement with workers, unions, employers, and government agencies.
- Prepared policy briefs, legislative memoranda, and analytical reports supporting parliamentary deliberation and policy development.
- Participated in labor dispute mediation and policy negotiations involving unions, employers, government agencies, and other institutional stakeholders.
- Represented the Democratic Labor Party in national minimum wage negotiations with labor federations (KCTU and FKTU), civil society organizations, and government representatives.
- Designed and conducted an international comparative study of Korean youth working abroad using surveys and qualitative interviews across the United States, Canada, Australia, and the United Kingdom.
- Provided policy research and legislative support for two National Assembly Audits (2010, 2011), contributing to parliamentary oversight work for which the legislator was recognized for outstanding performance.

Sergeant, Republic of Korea Army, Capital Defense Command 2012–2014
 Selected as Best Recruit and Best Squad Leader; received official commendations from the Division Commander (Major General) and the Commander of the Capital Defense Command (Lieutenant General).

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Labor Union Representative, SENS-UAW, The New School 2021–2023
 Represented academic workers in collective bargaining and institutional negotiations; organized language tutors and conducted internal investigations that secured recognition and compensation for unpaid training and waiting time.

Executive Director, General Students' Association, Yonsei University 2009–2010
 Campaign director for a successful university-wide election; directed executive operations and campus-wide governance and institutional reform initiatives.

Founder and Chair, Student Association for Transparency in University Fund Operations 2008–2009
 Led a university-wide financial transparency initiative that resulted in a landmark court ruling requiring disclosure of university fund records. Jointly with People's Solidarity for Participatory Democracy (PSPD), won a Supreme Court ruling (2013, No. 201du 5049, affirming Seoul Administrative Court No. 2009guhap7929) requiring the university to disclose the records.

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Statistical and Visualization Software: Stata, R, SPSS, Tableau

Certification: Nationally certified career counseling qualification (South Korea)

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research, U. Michigan 2022
 Partially funded by the Department of Public and Urban Policy, The New School for Social Research. Completed advanced coursework including Panel Data and Longitudinal Analysis, Time Series Analysis II: Advanced Topics, and Regression Analysis II: Linear Models.